



SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

TIPS

Linux Mint 63
 Deluge 65
 Safari For Windows 67
 Total Commander Ultima Prime 69

30 MINUTES EXPERT

Compiling From Source 66
 andLinux 68

LINUX MINT

Today we're looking at Linux Mint (www.linuxmint.com), another distribution derived from Ubuntu Linux. They claim it's very user friendly but it's also very appealing in looks. While most of the tips today were tested on Linux Mint, they will still run perfectly fine on your Ubuntu installations as well.

Restarting Gnome

Rebooting an operating system to get changes to come into effect is irritating because it's really slow and most of lack patience. When you're busy tweaking and want Gnome to be restarted every few minutes, you can restart it without rebooting the entire system. Save your work first and then press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Backspace]. Gnome will restart and you'll be returned to the login screen without rebooting within moments.

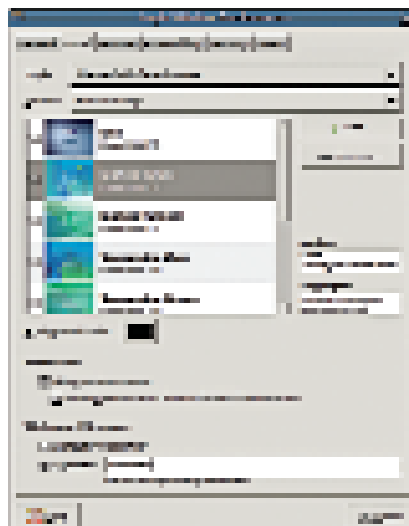
Automatically Logging Into Your Distribution

Linux Mint and even Ubuntu have the option of having your user name automatically logged in when your PC boots up. That way, you don't have to enter your user name and password every single time. It's also useful when you use remote desktop to login to Linux and the VNC server can't be accessed until you login.

In Linux Mint, click on the Start button and then click on Administration > Login Window. Enter your password and then click on the Security tab. Check the box for Enable Automatic Login. Use the dropdown menu to select the user to be automatically logged in.

Changing The Login Screen Theme

There's no denying that the login screen on Linux Mint looks very nice indeed. After a while, it gets boring and is always better to have a fancy theme greet you during login. Click on the Start button. Next, click on Administration > Login Window. Click on the Local tab and you can choose one from among the many themes in the list. A custom welcome message can be set using the text bar below. Sites like www.gnome-look.org, <http://art.gnome.org/> and www.customize.org have a large collection of themes, which you can download. Look specifically for GDM themes. New themes can be installed by clicking the Add button and browsing to the loca-



A variety of login screen themes are present in Ubuntu and Linux Mint

tion of the theme. Click Close when you are done.

Enable Complete Previewing Of Files In Nautilus

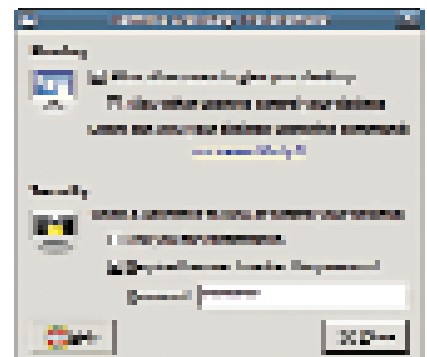
When you're using Nautilus to browse files, especially ones on a network, you may notice that some of the files do not generate previews like they do on your hard drive. This is because, by default, Nautilus only generates previews for local files. There is another limitation—only previews of local files smaller than 5 MB are generated.

To change these default settings, start Nautilus and then click on Edit > Preferences. Click the Preview tab. Here, you can change the values in the dropdown menu from Local Files Only to Always to Have previews generated for all locations. The limitation for files of certain sizes can be disabled by clicking on the dropdown for Only for files smaller than and Set the size from 5 MB to something larger. Click Close when done.

Remotely Accessing Your Linux Desktop

Say you've installed Linux Mint on a spare unused machine but don't have 2 monitors, you can use remote desktop to access the machine through a network. Remote desktop runs on VNC, so you can use any VNC client to connect to your server. TightVNC www.tightvnc.com is one VNC server/client that can be downloaded for free. You can also choose to download just the viewer.

To enable remote desktop, click on the Start button. Next, click on Preferences > Remote Desktop. Check the Allow other users to view your desktop checkbox and the one to Allow users to control it. If you want to have a password to be entered for security reasons, you can enable that too. By default, you need to authorise the user to be allowed access to the desktop, so disable the checkbox for Ask you for authorization.



Remote Desktop can be set up to allow secure remote control of your Linux PC